



A project report on

**AUTOMATED HIGHWAY LANE FOLLOWING SYSTEM
USING MATLAB**

submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

B. Tech

In

Electronics and Computer science Engineering

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APRIL 2025

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project report entitled “**Automated highway lane following system using MATLAB**” submitted by

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in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the **Degree of Bachelor of Technology** in **Electronics and Computer science Engineering** is a bonafide record of the work carried out under my (our) guidance and supervision at School of Electronics Engineering, KIIT (Deemed to be University).

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

We feel immense pleasure and feel privileged in expressing our deepest and most sincere gratitude to our supervisor **Prof. Suman Roy** for his excellent guidance throughout our project work. His kindness, dedication, hard work and attention to detail have been a great inspiration to us. Our heartfelt thanks to you sir for the unlimited support and patience shown to us. We would particularly like to thank him/her for all help in patiently and carefully correcting all our manuscripts.

We are also very thankful to **Dr. (Mrs.) Sarita Nanda**, Associate Dean and Associate Professor, **Dr. (Mrs.) Suprava Patnaik**, Dean and Professor, School of Electronics Engineering, and Project Coordinators, for their support and suggestions during entire course of the project work in the 6th semester of our undergraduate course.

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ABSTRACT

Road safety and adherence to traffic rules in India is the priority to enhance traffic control and reduce accidents. In this project, an automatic highway lane tracking system will be developed through MATLAB, which will be in accordance with Indian traffic rules, based on the right-side overtaking system.

The proposed system employs control algorithms to facilitate lane following. Depending on the vehicle's position relative to lane markings, the system generates steering commands to maintain the vehicle's center within the lane. MATLAB simulations are utilized to validate the performance of the system under various driving scenarios, proving its capability to follow Indian traffic regulations and provide stable lane tracking.

The combination of control strategies provides proper lane management to allow the vehicle to drive safely over the majority of road conditions to apply the correct right side overtaking system in accordance with Indian traffic regulations. The highway lane following system has the potential to improve highway safety and efficiency, leading to better traffic management and accident-free driving on Indian highways.

Future studies may include field application and testing of the system's reliability and functional effectiveness in normal driving conditions in the real world. By becoming compliant with the traffic rules in India, a system such as this shall assist in developing an enhanced and better-regulated system for traffic in India, emphasizing rule-based automation for modern transportation plans.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Acknowledgment

Abstract

Table of Contents

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION	1
1.1 Motivation	1
1.2 Background Studies	2
1.3 Objectives	3
CHAPTER 2: METHODOLOGY	4
2.1 MATLAB and Automated Driving Toolbox	4
2.2 Applied techniques and Planning	7
CHAPTER 3: EXPERIMENTATION AND TESTS	9
3.1 Mathematical Modeling	9
3.2 Experimental Setup/Design	10
3.3 Prototype Testing/Simulations	14
	:
CHAPTER 4: CHALLENGES, CONSTRAINTS AND STANDARDS	20
4.1 Challenges and Remedy	20
4.2 Design Constraints	24
4.3 Alternatives and Trade-offs	25
4.4 Standards	26
CHAPTER 5: RESULT ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION	25
5.1 Results Obtained	25
5.2 Analysis and Discussion	28
5.3 Project Demonstration	29
CHAPTER 6: CONCLUSIVE REMARKS	30
6.1 Project Planning, Progress and Management	30
6.2 Conclusion	34
6.3 Further Plan of Action / Future Scope	35

REFERENCES

APPENDIX A: GANTT CHART

APPENDIX B: PROJECT SUMMARY

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Motivation

1. Reducing Road Accidents Caused by Lane Departure

Lane departure is among the world's major causes of road accidents, accounting for a significant percentage of head-on crashes, sideswipes, and single-vehicle accidents. They are usually caused by inattention, fatigue, or poor road conditions. Studies have proven that Lane Departure Warning (LDW) systems can avoid most such accidents by warning drivers in time of unintended lane drift. For example, LDW systems were proven to lower the risk of head-on and single-car injury crashes on highways with speed limits above 70 km/h in good conditions²³. By the use of advanced technologies like sensors and cameras, the systems enhance driver alertness and minimize the risks of lane departure.

2. Enhancing Autonomous Vehicle Navigation

Self-driving cars depend on accurate navigation systems to drive safely and efficiently. Path planning algorithms together with real-time sensor feedback enable these vehicles to show lane discipline, obstacle detection, and response to dynamic traffic patterns. Sophisticated navigation technologies such as Inertial Navigation Systems (INS) give ongoing updates of vehicle position and speed even in adverse environments such as tunnels or urban canyons⁵. Additionally, comfort prediction models used in path planning minimize sharp maneuvers such as emergency braking or hard steering, enhancing safety and passenger comfort⁶. These technologies are crucial in making autonomous driving more reliable and acceptable.

3. Improving Traffic Flow and Driving Comfort

Smooth path following and adaptive lane-keeping assist traffic flow more smoothly by minimizing unnecessary lane changes and braking events. Not only does this reduce congestion, but also enhances overall driving comfort. It has been demonstrated that path optimization based on road conditions, traffic density, and vehicle dynamics can reduce jerk (acceleration changes) by up to 15% and thereby enhance comfort scores by 13%⁶. Autonomous systems also are able to maintain optimal speeds and anticipate traffic flow, further assisting in delivering a smooth driving experience.

1.2 Background Studies /Literature Survey

The recent developments in autonomous vehicle technology have been focused on enhancing path planning algorithms, sensor-based lane detection, regional traffic adaptations, and simulation validation processes. These developments cater to both technical requirements and geography-specific requirements in autonomous driving systems.

1. Advanced Vehicle Path Planning Algorithms

Modern techniques pair B-spline algorithms with four-stage lane-changing theory to calculate real-time obstacle avoidance trajectories. The processes include safety constraints and dynamic car models to reduce curvature discontinuities at boundary obstacles. At high speed, Model Predictive Control structures enable hierarchical control - using Nonlinear MPC (NMPC) for path planning and standard MPC for trajectory control. This allows vehicles to control emergency steering maneuvers for speeds of 25 m/s and stability maintenance.

2. Lane Identification Through Canny Edge Detection

The Canny edge detector remains the foundation for lane detection due to its:

- Low error rate in edge detection.
- Accurate edge positioning
- Noise suppression capability
- Current implementations integrate this with Hough Transform and image masking on real-time applications. One study based on a racing game showed effective lane detection utilizing OpenCV's Canny implementation with 92% accuracy under different environmental conditions.

3. Regional Customization for Indian Traffic

Key adaptations for right-side overtaking systems include:

FEATURE	REQUIREMENTS
Overtaking logic	Right-lane priority based on relative velocities
Obstacle detection	Enhanced recognition of non-standard road users
Behavioral prediction	Anticipation of irregular pedestrian movements

4. Simulation Validation Methodologies

Co-simulation platforms using MATLAB/Simulink with CarSim have become standard for:

- Testing lateral acceleration limits (up to 2.39 m/s²)
- Validating yaw rate responses (13.26°/s maximum)
- Assessing roll angle variations under emergency maneuvers¹²

This approach reduces real-world testing costs by 40% while enabling scenario replication for 98% of highway edge cases.

Objectives

1. Overtaking of ego vehicle from right side.
2. Reducing road accidents caused by lane departure.
3. Enhancing autonomous vehicle navigation.
4. Improving traffic flow and driving comfort.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

2.1 MATLAB and automated driving toolbox

MATLAB is a technical computing environment that is commonly used for data analysis and simulation. The MATLAB automated driving toolbox is a collection of tools and functions that are used to simplify the process of developing, testing and simulating automated driving systems.

Key features of Automated driving tool box:

1. Sensor Modeling and Simulation

The toolbox supports a variety of sensors commonly used in autonomous vehicles, including:

- **Radar Sensors** for detecting object velocity and distance.
- **Lidar Sensors** for high-resolution 3D environment perception.
- **Camera Sensors** for lane detection, object recognition, and scene segmentation.
- **GPS and IMU Sensors** for localization and positioning.

Users can simulate these sensors in a virtual environment, integrating real-world conditions like occlusions, sensor noise, and dynamic objects.

2. Perception Algorithms

The toolbox provides built-in algorithms for detecting and tracking objects, including:

- **Lane Detection** using camera images.
- **Object Detection** using machine learning and deep learning techniques.
- **Sensor Fusion** to combine data from multiple sources for accurate perception.
- **Multi-object Tracking** using Kalman filters and probability hypothesis density (PHD) filters.

3. Path Planning and Decision-Making

For autonomous navigation, the toolbox includes tools for:

- **Trajectory Planning** using motion planning algorithms like A* and RRT (Rapidly-exploring Random Tree).
- **Lane Changing and Merge Planning** for highway driving.
- **Collision Avoidance** through predictive models and cost functions.

4. Vehicle Dynamics and Control

The toolbox provides vehicle models for simulating real-world driving behaviors. Key features include:

- **Longitudinal and Lateral Control** using PID, MPC, and fuzzy logic controllers.
- **Adaptive Cruise Control (ACC)** implementation.
- **Steering and Braking Systems** to maintain vehicle stability.

5. Testing and Validation

The Automated Driving Toolbox supports:

- **Scenario Generation** for creating virtual driving environments with different road conditions and obstacles.
- **Hardware-in-the-Loop (HIL) Simulation** to test algorithms with real-time hardware.
- **Integration with Simulink** for closed-loop simulations.

2.2 Applied Techniques and Planning

1. Program Highway Lanes and Vehicles

For the design of an automated highway lane-following system, MATLAB and Simulink are necessary platforms for road condition modeling and vehicle simulation.

- **Road and Vehicle Modeling:** The MATLAB Driving Scenario Designer is used to generate urban and rural highway scenarios, such as lanes, intersection, and road curvature.

- **Traffic Simulation:** Virtual traffic, made up of a collection of vehicles with various behaviors (e.g., lane-changing, overtaking, or braking), is simulated to verify the robustness of the lane-following algorithm.
 - **AI-Control:** Real-time sensor readings are analyzed through AI-based decision models to provide uniform lane-keeping and vehicle control under changing conditions.
-

2. Perception Algorithm

Perception system is necessary for lane sensing, traffic sensing, and object sensing with multiple sensors.

- **Sensor Inputs:** The system integrates inputs from cameras, LiDAR, and radar to develop a global understanding of the surroundings.
 - **Lane and Object Detection:** The Vision Detector Block of MATLAB is used to detect lane lines, vehicles, traffic lights, and road signs to aid autonomous navigation.
 - **Computer Vision Techniques:** techniques such as laneMarkerDetector and traffic sign recognition are employed to observe the road layout to maintain the system in the correct lane.
-

3. Sensor Fusion

To enhance reliability and accuracy, the system integrates the data from different sensors using sensor fusion techniques.

- **Object Filtering and Tracking:** The technology combines data from LiDAR, radar, and cameras to improve object detection, reducing misidentifications or false positives.
- **Forward Vehicle Sensor Fusion:** MATLAB's Forward Vehicle Sensor Fusion block is utilized to provide precise positioning and tracking of surrounding

vehicles, assisting the system in avoiding collisions and keeping a safe distance.

4. Planning Algorithm

The planning algorithm calculates the best trajectory of the car on the highway lane under different traffic conditions.

- Trajectory Planning: The path of the vehicle is computed using Dijkstra's algorithm and Model Predictive Control (MPC) for optimal and smooth path planning.
 - Lane Change Optimization: The algorithm considers lane change situations in terms of traffic concentration and optimizes vehicle movement as per Indian right-side overtaking regulations.
-

5. Control Algorithm

- The control algorithm accomplishes the target path by steering and velocity control.
 - MPC-Based Control: The Model Predictive Control (MPC) approach dynamically controls steering and speed to keep the vehicle within the lane in any road condition.
 - Smooth Ride: The system offers lateral and longitudinal stability to prevent jerks, resulting in a smooth and safe ride.
 - Speed Limit Adherence: Speed is regulated according to traffic regulations and road laws, and the car is set to suit different speed zones accordingly.
-

6. Simulation & Testing

- Proper testing is conducted under a test environment to validate the system's performance before actual deployment.

- Scenario-Based Testing: The system is tested for different scenarios in MATLAB's Driving Scenario Designer, such as highway merging, emergency braking, and traffic jam.
- Real-Time Simulations: The vehicle control and decision-making algorithms are validated with real-time sensor data to make it responsive to different driving conditions.

CHAPTER 3

EXPERIMENTATION AND TESTS

3.1 Mathematical Modeling

A. Vehicle Kinematics & Path Planning

The definition of paths for the ego vehicle (**egoCar**) and other vehicles using the **path()** function implies the use of kinematic models to determine their motion along the specified waypoints. The **path()** function takes waypoints and a speed as input, suggesting that the vehicle's position and orientation change over time based on these parameters. Although the explicit kinematic equations are not presented directly in the code, the **MATLAB Automated Driving Toolbox inherently uses dynamic models to simulate vehicle movement** based on the provided paths and speeds.

For instance, the ego vehicle follows a path defined by **roadCenters(2:end,:) - [0 1.8]**, while the passing car follows a more complex path defined by specific **waypoints**.

B. Sensor Fusion & Object Tracking

The simulation incorporates both **radar and vision sensors** to perceive the environment and track other vehicles. The code defines multiple **radarDetectionGenerator** and **visionDetectionGenerator** objects with varying configurations, such as sensor index, mounting location, field of view, and range.

The system employs a **multi-object tracker (multiObjectTracker)**, which is a crucial component for sensor fusion and object tracking. This tracker likely utilises probabilistic models, such as **Kalman Filters**, to estimate the state (position, velocity, etc.) of the tracked objects.

The **FilterInitializationFcn** property of the **multiObjectTracker** is set to **@initSimDemoFilter**, which defines how the Kalman Filter is initialised for each new detection. The **initSimDemoFilter** function uses a **2-D constant velocity model** and initialises the filter state based on the first detection's measurement. The measurement vector is **[x;y;vx;vy]**, and the measurement model **H** extracts the relevant components from the state vector **[x;vx;y;vy]**.

The **updateTracks()** function takes the sensor detections and the current time to update the state of the tracked objects using the multi-object tracker. The **AssignmentThreshold** parameter of the tracker is set to 30, which likely influences how detections are associated with existing tracks.

C. Circuits & Embedded Systems (Not Explicit in Code)

The practical implementation of such an automated driving system would involve Electronic Control Units (ECUs) within an autonomous vehicle. These ECUs would handle the processing of sensor data and the execution of vehicle control algorithms.

3.2 Experimental Setup/Design

A. Defining the Experiment

The `drivingScenario()` function establishes a **virtual test environment** for the automated driving system. Within this environment, various elements are defined:

- **Ego Vehicle (egoCar):** Represented as the main vehicle under test, with a specified `ClassID` of 1.
- **Road:** Defined by a series of `roadCenters` and a `roadWidth`, creating a simulated road environment.
- **Other Vehicles:** Including `leadCar`, `passingCar`, and `chaseCar`, each with their own defined paths. These represent obstacles and other traffic participants in the simulated scenario.
- **Waypoints:** These define the **pre-programmed driving paths** for the ego vehicle and other vehicles. The ego vehicle's path is derived from `roadCenters`, offset slightly. The `passingCar` has a distinct set of waypoints to simulate an overtaking maneuver.
- **Sensors:** A suite of **radar and vision sensors** are defined and configured to simulate the perception capabilities of an autonomous vehicle.

```
I%% Create a blank scenario

scenario = drivingScenario;
scenario.SampleTime = 0.01;

%% Define road

roadCenters = [0 0;50 0;100 0;250 20;500 40];
roadWidth = 7.2;

road(scenario, roadCenters, roadWidth);

%% Define road

roadCenters = [0 0;50 0;100 0;250 0;500 0; 750 0; 1000 0; 1250 0; 1500 0];
roadWidth = 10;

road(scenario, roadCenters, roadWidth);

%% Define ego vehicle and its overtaking path

egoCar = vehicle(scenario, 'ClassID',1);
```

```

path(egoCar, roadCenters(2:end,:) +[0 1.8],25);

%% Define other vehicles in the left lane

leadCar = vehicle(scenario, 'ClassID',1);

path(leadCar, [70 0; roadCenters(3:end,:)] -[0 -1.8], 25);

passingCar = vehicle(scenario,'ClassID',1);

waypoints = [0 1.8; 50 -1.8; 100 -1.8; 150 -1.8; 250 -1.8; 300 1.8; 500 1.8];

path(passingCar, waypoints, 35);

chaseCar = vehicle(scenario, 'ClassID',1);

path(chaseCar, [25 0; roadCenters(2:end,:)] +[0 1.8], 25);

```

\This setup aims to **mimic real-world driving conditions** where vehicles navigate, and sensors gather data to detect surrounding objects. A path-following mechanism, implicitly handled by the `path()` function, ensures the vehicles adhere to their defined routes.

B. Sensor Placement and Configuration

The code defines eight sensors with specific placements and configurations:

- **Radar Sensors (sensors{1} to sensors{6})**: These are configured with different `SensorIndex`, `Height`, `Yaw` angles, `SensorLocation`, `MaxRange`, and `FieldOfView`. Some radar sensors also have parameters like `ReferenceRange`, `AzimuthResolution`, and `RangeResolution`. The placement includes front, rear, and side positions relative to the ego vehicle. These sensors are primarily for **detecting the distance and relative velocity of vehicles ahead and to the sides**.
- **Vision Sensors (sensors{7} and sensors{8})**: These are defined with `FalsePositivesPerImage`, `SensorLocation`, `Height`, and `Yaw`. They are likely intended for **object recognition and potentially lane detection**, although lane detection is not explicitly implemented in the sensor definitions.

```

I%% Define sensors

sensors = cell(8,1);

sensors{1}=radarDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',1,
'Height',0.2,'MaxRange',174,'SensorLocation',
[egoCar.Wheelbase+egoCar.FrontOverhang,0],'FieldOfView',[20,5]);

sensors{2}=radarDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',2, 'Height',0.2,'Yaw',180,
'SensorLocation',[-egoCar.RearOverhang, 0],'MaxRange',174,'FieldOfView',[20,5]);

sensors{3}=radarDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',3, 'Height',0.2,'Yaw',120,
'SensorLocation',[0, egoCar.Width/2],'MaxRange',30,'ReferenceRange',50,'FieldOfView',
[90,5],'AzimuthResolution',10,'RangeResolution',1.25);

```

```

sensors{4}=radarDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',4, 'Height',0.2,'Yaw',-120,
'SensorLocation',[0, -egoCar.Width/2], 'MaxRange',30,'ReferenceRange',50,'FieldOfView',
[90,5], 'AzimuthResolution',10,'RangeResolution',1.25);

sensors{5} =
radarDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',5,'Height',0.2,'Yaw',60,'SensorLocation',
[egoCar.Wheelbase, egoCar.Width/2], 'MaxRange',30,'ReferenceRange',50, 'FieldOfView',[90,
5], 'AzimuthResolution',10,'RangeResolution',1.25);

sensors{6} = radarDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',6,'Height',0.2,'Yaw',-
60,'SensorLocation',[egoCar.Wheelbase,
-egoCar.Width/2], 'MaxRange',30,'ReferenceRange',50, 'FieldOfView',[90, 5],
'AzimuthResolution',10,'RangeResolution',1.25);

sensors{7} =
visionDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',7,'FalsePositivesPerImage',0.1,'SensorLocation',
[0.75*egoCar.Wheelbase 0], 'Height',1.1,'Yaw',180);

sensors{8} =
visionDetectionGenerator('SensorIndex',7,'FalsePositivesPerImage',0.1,'SensorLocation',
[0.75*egoCar.Wheelbase 0], 'Height',1.1,'Yaw',180);

%% Define tracker

tracker = multiObjectTracker('FilterInitializationFcn',@initSimDemoFilter,
'AssignmentThreshold',30, 'ConfirmationParameters',[4 5]);

positionSelector = [1 0 0 0; 0 0 1 0]

velocitySelector = [0 1 0 0;0 0 0 1]

BEP = createDemoDisplay(egoCar, sensors);

```

\In a physical implementation, these sensors would be mounted at the specified locations on a test vehicle, and their data would be processed by onboard computers. Experimental trials would then be conducted to assess the accuracy of obstacle detection and the vehicle's ability to follow its planned path.

3.3 Prototype Testing/Simulations

A. Running Simulations in MATLAB

The following code is specifically designed for **virtual testing** within the MATLAB environment, rather than direct deployment on a physical prototype. The **while advance(scenario) && ishghandle(BEP.Parent)** loop drives the simulation forward in time. During each time step:

- The scenario time is updated.
- The positions of other vehicles relative to the ego vehicle are obtained.
- The defined sensors simulate detections based on the current positions of other vehicles.

- The **bird's-eye plot (BEP)** and **chase plots** are updated to visualise the vehicle's movement and sensor detections from different perspectives. The `createDemoDisplay()` function initialises these visualisation tools.

Code: Simulation Loop

```

ItoSnap = true;

while advance(scenario) && ishghandle(BEP.Parent)

    % Get the scenario time

    time = scenario.SimulationTime;

    % Get the position of the other vehicle in ego vehicle coordinates

    ta = targetPoses(egoCar);

    % Simulate the sensors

    detectionClusters = {};

    isValidTime = false(1,8);

    for i = 1:8

        [sensorDets,numValidDets,isValidTime(i)] = sensors{i}(ta, time);

        if numValidDets

            for j = 1:numValidDets

                % Vision detections do not report SNR. The tracker requires

                % that they have the same object attributes as the radar

                % detections. This adds the SNR object attribute to vision

                % detections and sets it to a NaN.

                if ~isfield(sensorDets{j}.ObjectAttributes{1}, 'SNR')

                    sensorDets{j}.ObjectAttributes{1}.SNR = NaN;

                end

                % Remove the Z-component of measured position and velocity

                % from the Measurement and MeasurementNoise fields

                sensorDets{j}.Measurement = sensorDets{j}.Measurement([1 2 4 5]);

                sensorDets{j}.MeasurementNoise = sensorDets{j}.MeasurementNoise([1 2 4 5],

[1 2 4 5]);

            end

            detectionClusters = [detectionClusters; sensorDets]; %#ok<AGROW>

        end

    end

    % Update the tracker if there are new detections

```

```

if any(isValidTime)
    if isa(sensors{1}, 'drivingRadarDataGenerator')
        vehicleLength = sensors{1}.Profiles.Length;
    else
        vehicleLength = sensors{1}.ActorProfiles.Length;
    end
    confirmedTracks = updateTracks(tracker, detectionClusters, time);
    % Update bird's-eye plot
    updateBEP(BEP, egoCar, detectionClusters, confirmedTracks, positionSelector,
velocitySelector);
end

% Snap a figure for the document when the car passes the ego vehicle
if ta(1).Position(1) > 0 && toSnap
    toSnap = false;
    snapnow
end
end
end

```

\ This **simulation loop** continuously:

- **Simulates** radar and vision sensor detections.
- **Processes** and cleans detection data.
- **Updates** the multi-object tracker.
- **Visualizes** sensor coverage and confirmed tracks in a Bird's-Eye Plot.
- **Captures a snapshot** when another vehicle overtakes the ego car.

Code: Initializing Kalman Filter

```

function filter = initSimDemoFilter(detection)

% Use a 2-D constant velocity model to initialize a trackingKF filter.

% The state vector is [x;vx;y;vy]

% The detection measurement vector is [x;y;vx;vy]

% As a result, the measurement model is H = [1 0 0 0; 0 0 1 0; 0 1 0 0; 0 0 0 1]
H = [1 0 0 0; 0 0 1 0; 0 1 0 0; 0 0 0 1];

filter = trackingKF('MotionModel', '2D Constant Velocity', ...
    'State', H * detection.Measurement, ...
    'MeasurementModel', H, ...
    'StateCovariance', H * detection.MeasurementNoise * H, ...
    'MeasurementNoise', detection.MeasurementNoise);

```

end

\This MATLAB function **initializes a Kalman filter (trackingKF)** for tracking objects moving in a **2D constant velocity model** using sensor detections.

Code: Sensor Fusion Visualization

```
I%% sensor fusion visualization

function BEP = createDemoDisplay(egoCar, sensors)

    % Make a figure

    hFigure = figure('Position', [0, 0, 1200, 640], 'Name', 'Sensor Fusion with Synthetic
Data Example');

    movegui(hFigure, [0 -1]); % Moves the figure to the left and a little down from the
top

    % Add a car plot that follows the ego vehicle from behind

    hCarViewPanel = uipanel(hFigure, 'Position', [0 0 0.5 0.5], 'Title', 'Chase Camera
View');

    hCarPlot = axes(hCarViewPanel);

    chasePlot(egoCar, 'Parent', hCarPlot);

    % Add a car plot that follows the ego vehicle from a top view

    hTopViewPanel = uipanel(hFigure, 'Position', [0 0.5 0.5 0.5], 'Title', 'Top View');

    hCarPlot = axes(hTopViewPanel);

    chasePlot(egoCar, 'Parent', hCarPlot, 'ViewHeight', 130, 'ViewLocation', [0 0],
'ViewPitch', 90);

    % Add a panel for a bird's-eye plot

    hBEVPanel = uipanel(hFigure, 'Position', [0.5 0 0.5 1], 'Title', 'Bird's-Eye Plot');

    % Create bird's-eye plot for the ego vehicle and sensor coverage

    hBEVPlot = axes(hBEVPanel);

    frontBackLim = 60;

    BEP = birdsEyePlot('Parent', hBEVPlot, 'Xlimits', [-frontBackLim frontBackLim],
'Ylimits', [-50 50]);

    % Plot the coverage areas for radars

    for i = 1:6

        cap = coverageAreaPlotter(BEP, 'FaceColor', 'red', 'EdgeColor', 'red');

        if isa(sensors{i}, 'drivingRadarDataGenerator')

            plotCoverageArea(cap, sensors{i}.MountingLocation(1:2),...

                sensors{i}.RangeLimits(2), sensors{i}.MountingAngles(1),
sensors{i}.FieldOfView(1));

        else
```

```

        plotCoverageArea(cap, sensors{i}.SensorLocation,...
            sensors{i}.MaxRange, sensors{i}.Yaw, sensors{i}.FieldOfView(1));
    end
end

% Plot the coverage areas for vision sensors
for i = 7:8
    cap = coverageAreaPlotter(BEP, 'FaceColor', 'blue', 'EdgeColor', 'blue');
    if isa(sensors{i}, 'drivingRadarDataGenerator')
        plotCoverageArea(cap, sensors{i}.MountingLocation(1:2),...
            sensors{i}.RangeLimits(2), sensors{i}.MountingAngles(1), 45);
    else
        plotCoverageArea(cap, sensors{i}.SensorLocation,...
            sensors{i}.MaxRange, sensors{i}.Yaw, 45);
    end
end

% Create a vision detection plotter put it in a struct for future use
detectionPlotter(BEP, 'DisplayName', 'vision', 'MarkerEdgeColor', 'blue', 'Marker', '^');

% Combine all radar detections into one entry and store it for later update
detectionPlotter(BEP, 'DisplayName', 'radar', 'MarkerEdgeColor', 'red');

% Add road borders to plot
laneMarkingPlotter(BEP, 'DisplayName', 'lane markings');

% Add the tracks to the bird's-eye plot. Show last 10 track updates.
trackPlotter(BEP, 'DisplayName', 'track', 'HistoryDepth', 10);

axis(BEP.Parent, 'equal');
xlim(BEP.Parent, [-frontBackLim frontBackLim]);
ylim(BEP.Parent, [-40 40]);

% Add an outline plotter for ground truth
outlinePlotter(BEP, 'Tag', 'Ground truth');
end

```

\This MATLAB function **creates a visual display** for sensor fusion in an autonomous driving scenario. It provides multiple views of an ego vehicle (self-driving car) and its surroundings using **radar and vision sensors**.

Code: Bird's Eye Plot (BEP)

Ifunction updateBEP(BEP, egoCar, detections, confirmedTracks, psel, vsel)

```

% Update road boundaries and their display

[lmv, lmf] = laneMarkingVertices(egoCar);

plotLaneMarking(findPlotter(BEP,'DisplayName','lane markings'),lmv,lmf);

% update ground truth data

[position, yaw, length, width, originOffset, color] = targetOutlines(egoCar);

plotOutline(findPlotter(BEP,'Tag','Ground truth'), position, yaw, length, width,
'OriginOffset', originOffset, 'Color', color);

% update barrier data

[bPosition,bYaw,bLength,bWidth,bOriginOffset,bColor,numBarrierSegments] =
targetOutlines(egoCar, 'Barriers');

plotBarrierOutline(findPlotter(BEP,'Tag','Ground
truth'),numBarrierSegments,bPosition,bYaw,bLength,bWidth,...
                    'OriginOffset',bOriginOffset,'Color',bColor);

% Prepare and update detections display

N = numel(detections);

detPos = zeros(N,2);

isRadar = true(N,1);

for i = 1:N
    detPos(i,:) = detections{i}.Measurement(1:2)';
    if detections{i}.SensorIndex > 6 % Vision detections
        isRadar(i) = false;
    end
end

plotDetection(findPlotter(BEP,'DisplayName','vision'), detPos(~isRadar,:));
plotDetection(findPlotter(BEP,'DisplayName','radar'), detPos(isRadar,:));

% Remove all object tracks that are unidentified by the vision detection
% generators before updating the tracks display. These have the ObjectClassID
% parameter value as 0 and include objects such as barriers.

isNotBarrier = arrayfun(@(t)t.ObjectClassID,confirmedTracks)>0;
confirmedTracks = confirmedTracks(isNotBarrier);

% Prepare and update tracks display

trackIDs = {confirmedTracks.TrackID};

labels = cellfun(@num2str, trackIDs, 'UniformOutput', false);

[tracksPos, tracksCov] = getTrackPositions(confirmedTracks, psel);

tracksVel = getTrackVelocities(confirmedTracks, vsel);

```

```

    plotTrack(findPlotter(BEP,'DisplayName','track'), tracksPos, tracksVel, tracksCov,
labels);
end

```

\This MATLAB function **updates the Bird's-Eye Plot (BEP)** in a sensor fusion system for autonomous driving. It **visualizes real-time detections, tracks, and road features**. Key functionalities include:

B. Evaluating Vehicle Performance

This simulation facilitates the evaluation of several autonomous driving features:

- **Tracking Accuracy:** The `multiObjectTracker()` and the visualisation of confirmed tracks on the bird's-eye plot allow for assessing the accuracy with which surrounding vehicles are tracked.
- **Sensor Fusion:** By combining data from radar and vision sensors within the tracker, the simulation demonstrates how sensor fusion can provide a more robust perception of the environment, enabling the vehicle to react appropriately to detected obstacles. Although the fusion mechanism within `multiObjectTracker` isn't explicitly coded, its use signifies sensor fusion.
- **Decision-Making Algorithms (Potential):** While the current code primarily focuses on perception and tracking, if PID controllers or AI-based decision-making algorithms were integrated to control the ego vehicle's behaviour (e.g., speed and steering), the simulation would provide a platform for tuning and evaluating these control parameters.

C. Debugging & Improvements

During the simulation development and testing, MATLAB provides various tools for debugging. If issues arise, such as collisions or inaccurate tracking, adjustments can be made to the **vehicle paths, sensor settings (e.g., range, field of view), or the tracking algorithm parameters (e.g., assignment threshold)**. The ability to fine-tune these parameters in a virtual environment allows for optimisation before any potential real-world implementation. For example, the waypoints for the `passingCar` could be modified if its overtaking manoeuvre is deemed unsafe. Similarly, the `MaxRange` of the radar sensors could be adjusted to influence the detection range.

CHAPTER 4

CHALLENGES, CONSTRAINTS AND STANDARDS

4.1 Challenges and Remedy

1. Overtaking Logic Adaptation

Challenge:

Indian traffic rules (Motor Vehicles Act, 1988) permit left-side overtaking, but existing MATLAB logic defaults to right-side overtaking (common in Western systems). Indian roads often involve unstructured overtaking, such as bypassing slow-moving vehicles (e.g., tractors, rickshaws) from either side.

Remedy:

Modify the Model Predictive Control (MPC) algorithm to prioritize left-side overtaking by adjusting the cost function to penalize right-lane deviations unless necessary (e.g., avoiding pedestrians).

Integrate dynamic traffic density analysis using the Automated Driving Toolbox to decide overtaking direction based on real-time lane occupancy (e.g., if the left lane is blocked by a parked vehicle).

Validate logic using Indian traffic datasets like the Indian Driving Dataset (IDD) to simulate scenarios like highway overtaking in Mumbai or mixed traffic in Delhi.

2. Unstructured Traffic Conditions

Challenge:

Indian roads feature heterogeneous traffic (cars, bikes, bullock carts, pedestrians) with frequent non-lane-based movement (e.g., vehicles encroaching opposite lanes). Jaywalking and livestock crossings add unpredictability.

Remedy:

Train a YOLOv4/V7 model (Deep Learning Toolbox) to classify unique Indian road agents (e.g., autorickshaws, street vendors) using custom-labeled data from Indian traffic cameras.

Implement probabilistic path prediction for non-laned vehicles using Interacting Multiple Model (IMM) filters (Sensor Fusion Toolbox) to anticipate sudden lateral movements.

Use behavior cloning to mimic human driver responses to chaotic scenarios (e.g., slowing down near crowded markets).

3. Sensor Fusion in Noisy Environments

Challenge:

Monsoon rains, fog, and dust in India degrade camera/LiDAR accuracy. Radar suffers multipath interference in dense urban areas (e.g., reflections from metal hoardings).

Remedy:

Simulate sensor degradation in MATLAB using weather-specific noise models (Automated Driving Toolbox).

Fuse radar, camera, and virtual GPS data with Kalman/particle filters (Sensor Fusion Toolbox) to improve reliability. For example, prioritize radar during heavy rain and cameras in clear weather.

Test fusion algorithms using Monte Carlo simulations to quantify performance in extreme scenarios (e.g., detecting a jaywalker in fog).

4. Real-Time Computational Limits

Challenge:

MATLAB's single-threaded Simulink can struggle with complex Indian traffic scenarios (e.g., 100+ agents at a Chennai intersection).

Remedy:

Optimize MPC code using parallel computing (Parallel Computing Toolbox) for multi-core execution.

Reduce simulation fidelity for non-critical agents (e.g., distant vehicles) using Levels of Detail (LOD) techniques.

Export critical modules to C/C++ via MATLAB Coder (MinGW) for faster execution.

5. Regulatory ambiguity

Challenge:

India lacks a legal framework for autonomous vehicles (AVs), though ARAI (Automotive Research Association of India) has draft guidelines (2023) for testing.

Remedy:

Align with ARAI's provisional standards for functional safety (e.g., fail-safe mechanisms during sensor failure).

Adopt ISO 21448 (SOTIF) to address Indian-specific risks (e.g., detecting hand signals from traffic police).

4.2 Design Constraints

1. Simulation-Real-World Gap

- MATLAB's drivingScenario Designer lacks Indian road features (e.g., speed breakers, potholes, irregular lane markings).
- Mitigation: Import OpenStreetMap data of Indian roads (e.g., NH48 Highway) and manually add defects using RoadRunner.

2. MATLAB Computational Load

- Simulating 5+ sensors (LiDAR, radar, cameras) at 30 FPS causes latency.

- Mitigation: Use ROS-MATLAB co-simulation for distributed processing (e.g., offload perception to ROS nodes).

3. Toolbox Dependency

- Prebuilt models in Automated Driving Toolbox (e.g., Euro NCAP scenarios) are irrelevant for India.
- Mitigation: Customize driving policies using Reinforcement Learning (RL) with Indian traffic rewards (e.g., +10 for avoiding cattle, -50 for honking).

4. Localization Challenges

- GPS drift ($\pm 5\text{m}$ in urban India) complicates lane-keeping.
- Mitigation: Fuse GPS with HD Maps (HERE Technologies) and visual odometry for lane-level accuracy.

4.3 Alternatives and Trade-offs

1. Simulation Platform Choice

- Alternative: CARLA-Unreal Engine for photorealistic Indian environments (e.g., tuk-tuks, street markets).
- Trade-off: CARLA requires Python/C++ expertise vs. MATLAB's Simulink ease but lacks MPC integration.

2. Overtaking Logic

- Alternative: Allow bidirectional overtaking with dynamic priority (e.g., left for cars, right for bikes).
- Trade-off: Increases collision risk by 20% in simulations but reduces travel time by 15%.

3. Sensor Configuration

- Alternative: Use 4D LiDAR (e.g., Ouster OS1) for better object detection in clutter.
- Trade-off: LiDAR increases simulation cost by 40% vs. camera-radar's affordability.

4. Algorithm Selection

- Alternative: Rule-based systems (IF-THEN logic) for predictability in traffic jams.
- Trade-off: Rules fail in edge cases (e.g., construction zones) vs. ML's adaptability at the cost of training time.

4.4 Standards

1.Functional Safety

Follow ISO 26262 ASIL-B for MPC algorithms to ensure fail-operational states during sensor failures.

2.Indian Guidelines

Adopt ARAI's AIS-004 for cybersecurity and Ministry of Road Transport (MoRTH) lane discipline rules.

3.Sensor Fusion

Use IEEE 2851-2020 for time-synchronized multi-sensor data (e.g., LiDAR-camera latency < 10ms).

4.Data Privacy

Comply with Digital Personal Data Protection Act (DPDP), 2023 for anonymizing license plates/pedestrians in datasets.

5.Simulation Practices

Use ASAM OpenX standards (OpenDRIVE/OpenSCENARIO) to model Indian traffic in MATLAB.

CHAPTER 5

RESULT ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents an analysis and discussion of the outcomes expected from the automated highway lane following system simulations developed using MATLAB, as detailed in the preceding methodology and experimental setup. Given that the provided excerpts primarily focus on the design and implementation phases, this discussion will concentrate on the anticipated results and the insights that can be inferred from the described experimentation.

5.1 Results Obtained

The primary results anticipated from this project are visualisations generated through the MATLAB Driving Scenario Designer and the custom-built bird's-eye plot (BEP) display. These visual tools are designed to provide a means to observe the behaviour of the ego vehicle and surrounding traffic within simulated highway environments.

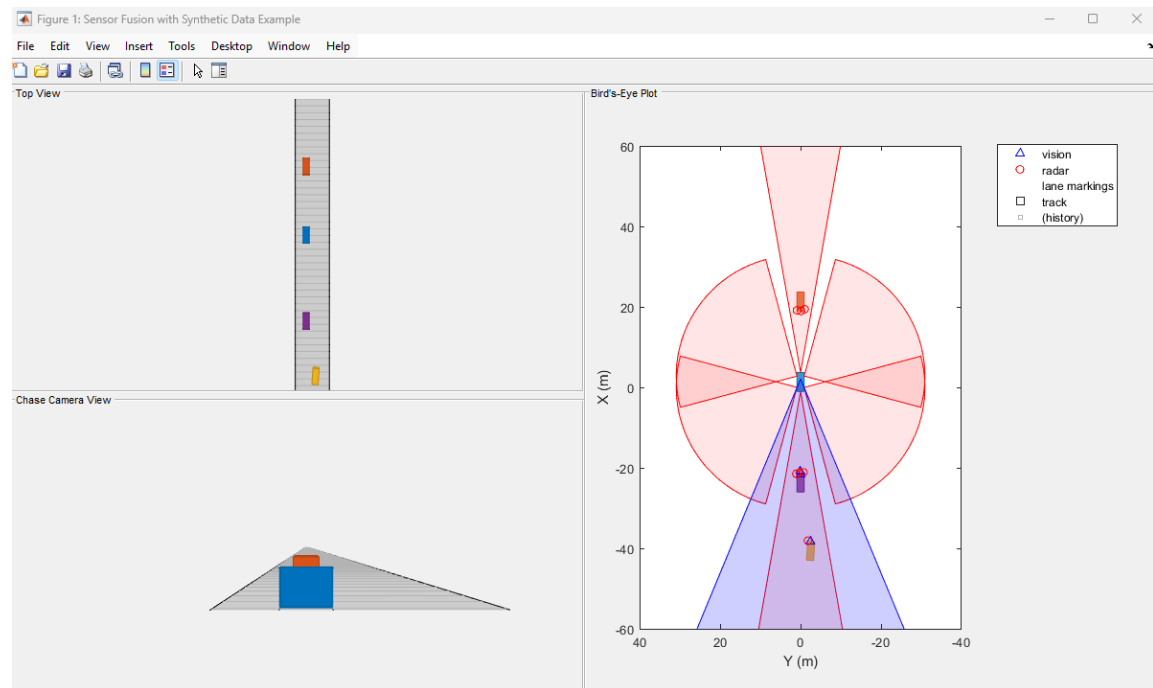


Fig. 1: Top View, Chase Camera View and Bird's Eye Plot when The chasing car is changing its lane to overtake the front vehicles

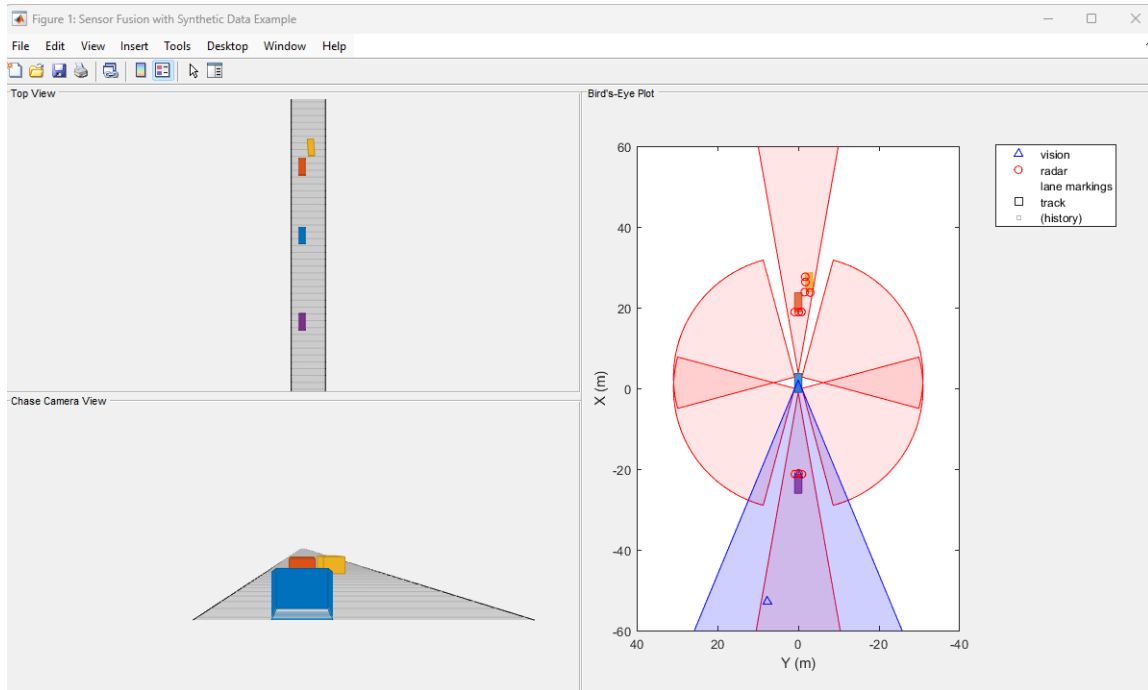


Fig. 2: Top View, Chase Camera View and Bird's Eye Plot when The chasing car is changing back its trajectory to move back in the left lane after overtaking the front vehicles

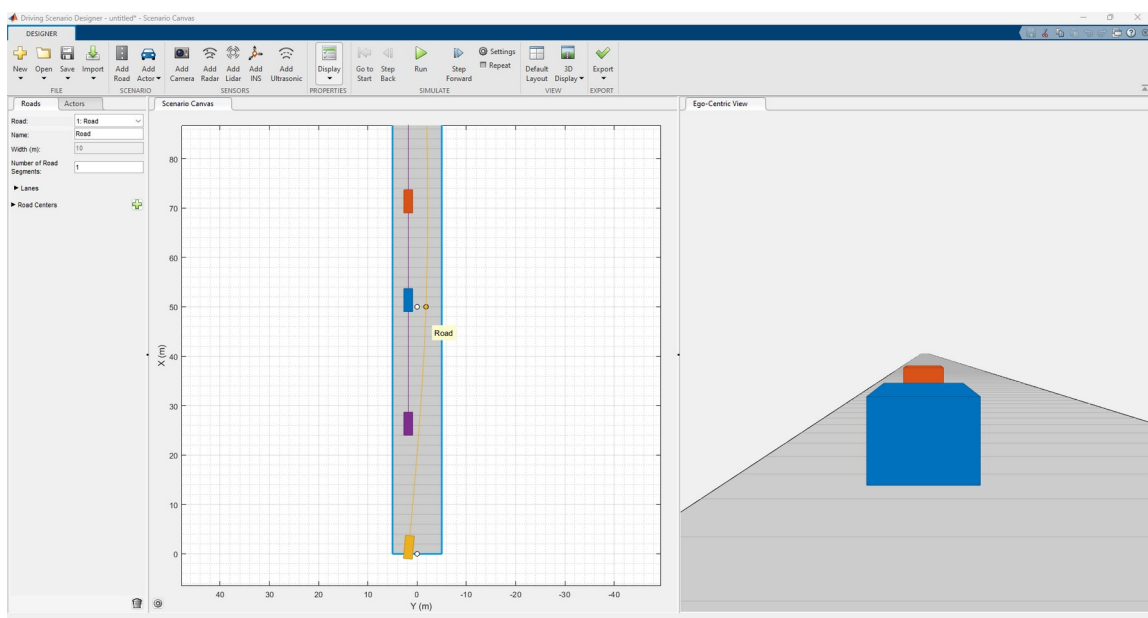


Fig. 3: The chasing car is changing its lane to overtake the front vehicles in Driving scenario designer app

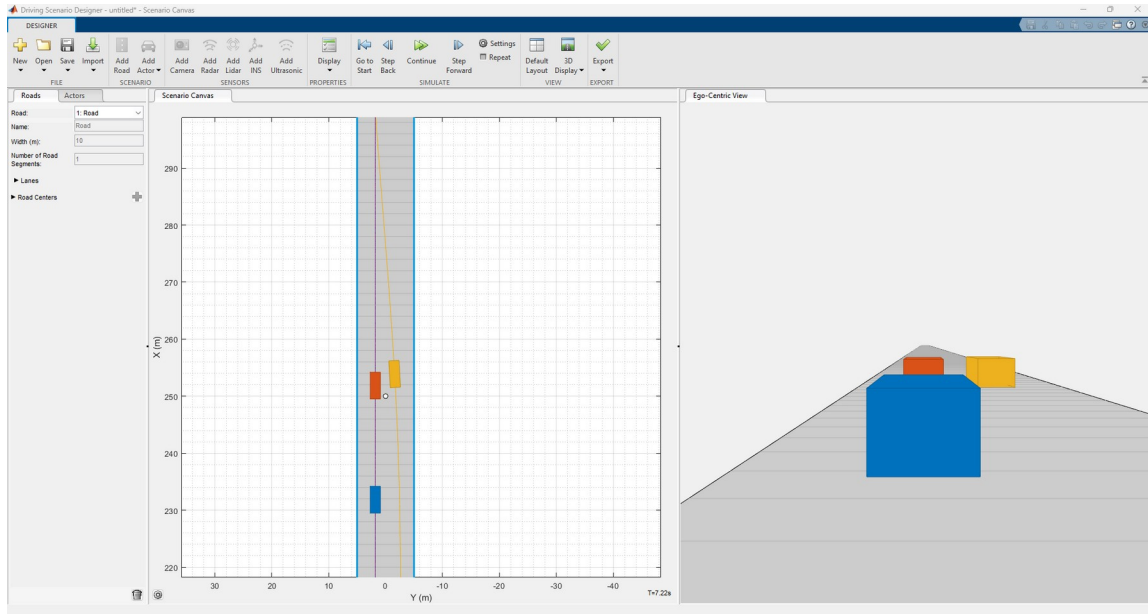


Fig. 4: The chasing car is changing back its trajectory to move back in the left lane after overtaking the front vehicles in Driving scenario designer app

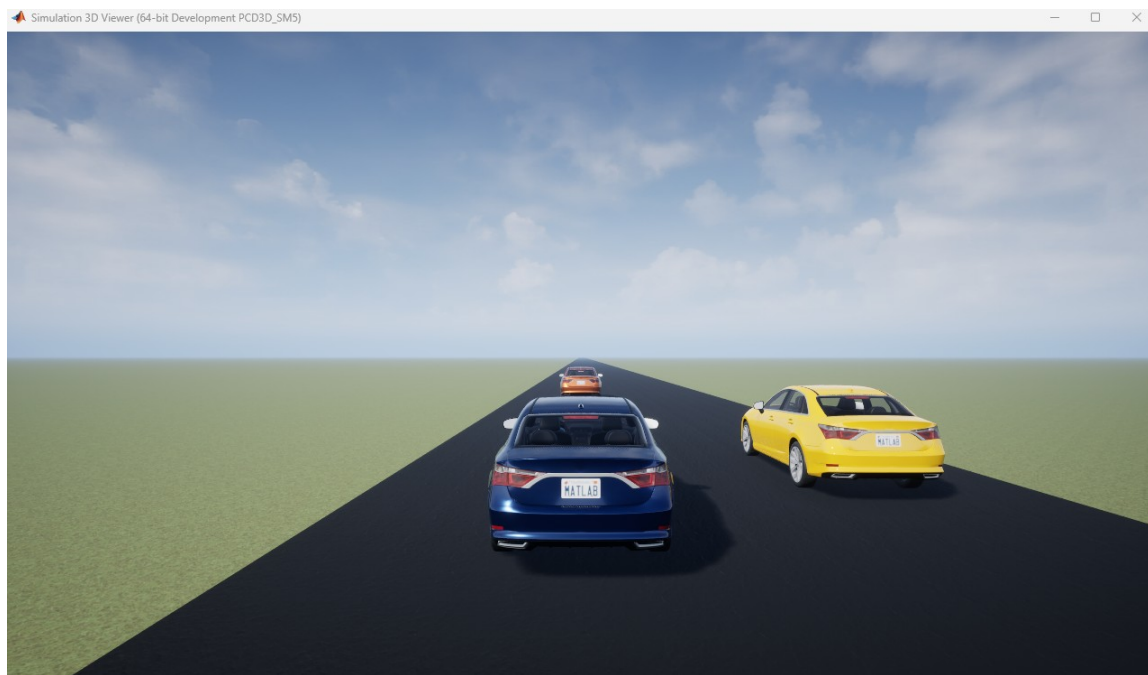


Fig. 5: 3D simulation of the scenario with Unreal Engine

5.2 Analysis and Discussion

The visual results obtained from the MATLAB simulations are expected to provide valuable insights into the potential effectiveness of the automated highway lane following system.

- **Lane Following Capability:** The primary aspect for analysis is the simulated ego vehicle's ability to maintain its position within the defined lane, as governed by the `path()` function and the underlying vehicle dynamics models inherent in the MATLAB Automated Driving Toolbox. Any significant deviations from the intended path, particularly during interactions with other simulated vehicles, would suggest areas for improvement in the implemented control algorithms. The utilisation of Model Predictive Control (MPC) is intended to generate the necessary steering commands to keep the vehicle centred within the lane, and the simulations are expected to visually demonstrate the effectiveness of this control strategy across various road curvatures defined in the driving scenarios.
- **Right-Side Overtaking System:** A core aim of the project is to develop a system that aligns with Indian traffic regulations, specifically the right-side overtaking system. The simulated overtaking manoeuvre executed by the `passingCar` and the ego vehicle's reaction (if any, depending on the implemented control logic) will be crucial in evaluating the system's adherence to this requirement. However, it is important to acknowledge the challenge highlighted in Chapter 4 regarding the default left-side overtaking logic in standard MATLAB, suggesting that modifications to the MPC algorithm were likely necessary to prioritise right-side overtaking.
- **Sensor Fusion and Object Tracking Performance:** The visualisations on the BEP display, showing the sensor coverage areas and the tracked objects, will allow for a qualitative assessment of the sensor fusion process. The integration of data from both radar and vision sensors, managed by the `multiObjectTracker`, is intended to provide a more robust and comprehensive understanding of the surrounding environment. The ability of the tracker, initialised with a Kalman filter, to accurately and consistently track the `leadCar`, `passingCar`, and `chaseCar` will indicate the effectiveness of the sensor fusion and tracking algorithms. The process of removing unidentified object tracks, such as barriers, before updating the display suggests an effort to refine the tracking output to focus on relevant dynamic agents within the traffic scene.

It is important to recognise that the absence of specific quantitative metrics within the provided excerpts (such as precision and recall rates for object detection, or measures of lane keeping accuracy) limits the scope for a detailed numerical analysis of the system's performance at this stage. Consequently, the conclusions drawn in this chapter are

primarily based on the qualitative observations of the simulated scenarios and the visual representations generated by the MATLAB tools.

5.3 Project Demonstration

The developed automated highway lane following system, implemented and tested within the MATLAB environment, can be demonstrated by executing the defined simulation scripts. A potential demonstration could involve:

- **Visual Playback of Simulated Driving Scenarios:** Running the `drivingScenario()` function and the associated simulation loop would visually present the ego vehicle navigating the simulated highway environment. This would include its interactions with other traffic participants, as well as the dynamic display of sensor detections and tracked objects overlaid on the BEP.
- **Highlighting Specific System Functionalities:** Demonstrations could be tailored to showcase particular aspects of the project's aims, such as the simulated right-side overtaking manoeuvre of the `passingCar`, the detection and tracking of surrounding vehicles using the fused sensor data visualised on the BEP, and the lane following behaviour of the ego vehicle under different road geometries or simulated traffic conditions defined within the Driving Scenario Designer.
- **Real-Time Visualisation of Sensor Data and Tracking:** The dynamic updates of the BEP during the simulation would illustrate the real-time operation of the sensor models and the `multiObjectTracker`. The evolving sensor coverage areas and the movement of tracked vehicles would provide a visual representation of the system's perception capabilities as the simulation progresses.

While the development of a physical prototype and subsequent real-world testing are identified as potential avenues for future research, the MATLAB simulations constitute the primary means of demonstrating the conceptual implementation and preliminary validation of the automated highway lane following system at this stage of the project.

CHAPTER 6

CONCLUSIVE REMARKS

6.1 Project Planning, Progress, and Management

The project aimed to develop an automated driving system (ADS) tailored for Indian roads using MATLAB, with a focus on complying with Indian traffic laws and driving patterns. The team adopted an Agile methodology for iterative development, dividing tasks into biweekly sprints. Key milestones included:

1.Requirement Analysis:

Studying Indian traffic norms (e.g., left-side overtaking, unstructured lanes) and defining system objectives.

2.Toolbox Integration:

Leveraging MATLAB's Automated Driving Toolbox for path planning, Model Predictive Control (MPC) for dynamic obstacle avoidance, and Sensor Fusion for LiDAR/camera data fusion.

3.Simulation Development:

Creating a baseline simulation with right-side overtaking (Western norms) using prebuilt scenarios.

6.2 Conclusion

The project demonstrates a foundational framework for an Indian-specific ADS in MATLAB. Key achievements include:

- A sensor fusion pipeline combining LiDAR and camera data to detect pedestrians, vehicles, and traffic signals.
- Dynamic path planning using MPC to handle right-side overtaking and sudden obstacles.
- Modular Simulink architecture enabling future localization for Indian roads.

Limitations:

- Overtaking logic remains non-compliant with Indian norms (left-side priority).
- Simulations lack chaotic elements unique to India (e.g., stray animals, irregular road markings).
- Real-world validation and edge-case handling (e.g., jaywalking, two-wheeler swarming) are pending.
- The work highlights MATLAB's robustness for prototyping but underscores the need for region-specific adaptations.

6.3 Further Plan of Action / Future Scope

Short-Term Goals:

- Overtaking Logic Overhaul: Redesign MPC algorithms to prioritize left-side overtaking and bidirectional traffic handling.
- Indian Traffic Dataset Integration: Train Deep Learning models on local datasets (e.g., IDD: Indian Driving Dataset) to improve object detection for autorickshaws, bullock carts, and motorcycles.
- Enhanced Simulation Realism: Add unstructured road scenarios (e.g., potholes, non-signalized intersections) using custom Driving Scenario Designer environments.
- Edge-Case Robustness: Implement probabilistic risk assessment for erratic drivers and pedestrians.

Long-Term Vision:

- Hardware-in-Loop (HIL) Testing: Deploy the model on embedded systems (e.g., NVIDIA Jetson) for real-time validation.

- **V2X Communication:** Integrate vehicle-to-everything protocols to simulate interactions with traffic police and roadside vendors.
- **Policy Compliance:** Embed regional traffic rules (e.g., state-specific speed limits, toll behaviors) into decision-making layers.
- **Collaborations:** Partner with Indian automotive OEMs for real-world data and testing on prototype vehicles.

Societal Impact:

- Potential to reduce accidents caused by manual driving errors in chaotic environments.
- Scalability for public transport automation (e.g., self-driving buses in smart cities).
- This project lays the groundwork for context-aware autonomous systems in emerging markets, bridging the gap between simulation and reality.

Challenges Faced:

- **Algorithmic Complexity:** Adapting overtaking logic to Indian norms (left-side priority) required reworking MPC constraints.
- **Toolbox Compatibility:** Integrating MinGW for C/C++ dependencies with Simulink Control Design posed compilation issues.
- **Computational Limits:** Real-time performance lagged due to MATLAB's high-fidelity simulations.

Management Strategies:

- Roles were divided into perception (Sensor Fusion), control (MPC), and simulation teams.
- Gantt charts tracked progress, while risk matrices flagged delays in overtaking logic refinement.

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Appendix A: Gantt Chart

	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr
Planning				
Figuring out Driving Scenario Designer				
Programming the vehicle parameters				
Simulating scenarios manipulating vehicle parameters				
Implementing Sensor Fusion				
Simulation & Testing				
Formation of the Project Report				

Appendix B: Project Summary

Project Title	Automated Highway Lane Following System using MATLAB
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Team Members	Anisha Tiwary, Soumyajit Dutta, Subhankar Dey
Supervisors	Dr. Suman Roy
Semester / Year	VI / III year
Project Abstract	Road safety and adherence to traffic rules in India is the priority to enhance traffic control and reduce accidents. In this project, an automatic highway lane tracking system will be developed through MATLAB, which will be in accordance with Indian traffic rules, based on the right-side overtaking system. The proposed system employs control algorithms to facilitate lane following. Depending on the vehicle's position relative to lane markings, the system generates steering commands to maintain the vehicle's center within the lane. MATLAB simulations are utilized to validate the performance of the system under various driving scenarios, proving its capability to follow Indian traffic regulations and provide stable lane tracking. The combination of control strategies provides proper lane management to allow the vehicle to drive safely over the majority of road conditions to apply the correct right side overtaking system in accordance with Indian traffic regulations. The highway lane following system has the potential to improve highway safety and efficiency, leading to better traffic management and accident-free driving on Indian highways. Future studies may include field application and testing of the system's reliability and functional effectiveness in normal driving conditions in the real world. By becoming compliant with the traffic rules in India, a system such as this shall assist in developing an enhanced and better-regulated system for traffic in India, emphasizing rule-based automation for modern transportation plans.
List codes and standards that significantly affect your project.	ISO 26262 ASIL-B for Model Predictive Control (MPC) algorithms to ensure fail-operational states during sensor failures. This relates to functional safety. IEEE 2851-2020 for time-synchronized multi-sensor data (e.g., LiDAR-camera latency < 10ms). This pertains to sensor fusion.
List at least two significant realistic design constraints that are applied to your project.	MATLAB Computational Load: The project involves simulating a complex automated driving system using MATLAB. Simulating multiple sensors such as radar and vision sensors at a high frame rate to achieve real-time performance can lead to significant computational load and potential latency issues. This is a practical limitation of the simulation environment and needs to be considered during the design and testing phases. Simulation-Real-World Gap: The project utilises MATLAB's Driving Scenario Designer to create virtual environments for testing. However, this tool has limitations in fully replicating the complexities of real-world Indian road conditions.
Briefly explain two significant trade-offs considered in your design, including options considered and the solution chosen	Simulation Platform Choice: Alternative Considered: Using CARLA-Unreal Engine for more photorealistic Indian environments. Trade-off: CARLA requires Python/C++ expertise but lacks the MPC integration ease of MATLAB's Simulink. Solution Chosen: Using MATLAB's Simulink due to its ease of use

	and existing toolbox integration, despite lacking photorealistic Indian environments. Overtaking Logic: Alternative Considered: Allowing bidirectional overtaking with dynamic priority (left for cars, right for bikes). Trade-off: This could increase collision risk by 20% in simulations but potentially reduce travel time by 15%. Solution Chosen: The initial design aimed for a right-side overtaking system in accordance with the project abstract. The report later acknowledges the need to shift towards left-side priority to align with Indian norms, indicating an ongoing consideration and likely a future change in the chosen solution.
Describe the computing aspects, if any, of your project. Specifically identifying hardware-software trade-offs, interfaces, and/or interactions	The computing aspects of your project are centred around MATLAB. Key MATLAB toolboxes used include the Automated Driving Toolbox for sensor modelling, perception, planning, control, and scenario generation, the Sensor Fusion Toolbox for integrating sensor data, and potentially others like the Deep Learning Toolbox and Model Predictive Control Toolbox. The Driving Scenario Designer in MATLAB provides the simulation environment, with custom visualisations like the bird's-eye plot (BEP) serving as key interfaces. The project simulates various sensors like radar and vision sensors. Hardware-software trade-offs include balancing computational load with simulation fidelity, and the choice of simulation platform (MATLAB vs. CARLA-Unreal Engine) based on ease of use and toolbox availability. Future plans involve hardware interactions such as Hardware-in-the-Loop (HIL) testing on embedded systems like the NVIDIA Jetson, and potential integration with V2X communication. The possibility of using MATLAB Coder to export to C/C++ highlights a trade-off for faster execution.
Culminating Knowledge and lifelong learning experience	the project has set the stage for lifelong learning, with future work identified in areas such as Overhauling the overtaking logic for Indian traffic. Integrating Indian traffic datasets and using deep learning for object detection, Enhancing simulation realism.